

First Day Handout

Course Information

Course: CSC111 Computer Forensics SP21
Semester: Spring 2021
Instructor: Mr. Patrick Earl
Office: OM252
Office Phone: 610 683 4434
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Faculty Web Page: <https://csit.kutztown.edu/~earl>
Office Hours: Monday: 2:00 PM - 4:00 PM
Tuesday: 3:00 PM - 4:00 PM
Wednesday: 4:00 PM - 5:00 PM

Always refer to my website for the latest office hours.

Meetings: Tuesdays/Thursdays 3:00PM - 4:20PM

Format: Hybrid (Sync In-Person/Zoom)

Materials

Required Textbook

- TBD

Description

This course is an introduction to the basic concepts of computer forensics. It will teach the student how to identify, preserve, recover, analyze and document data on a computer or network allegedly used to commit a crime. Topics include computer architecture, operating systems, encryption/decryption, preserve and document evidence, and analyzing computers and networks for evidence.

Objectives

1. Summarize the importance of security for computer and network systems.
2. Describe the role of computer forensics in an alleged crime.
3. States a basic knowledge of computers and networks.
4. Explain the ethic and social implications of technology.
5. Describe the major security threats and vulnerabilities to computers and networks, including viruses, worms, and trojans.
6. Explain basic encryption and decryption techniques.
7. Explain basic hacker techniques and how to defend against them.
8. Describe how to preserve and critical evidence in computers and networks.
9. Demonstrate the ability to perform a basic analysis for computer forensics using various tools.

Grading

Your final course grade will be made up of the following:

- Semi-Weekly Quizzes: 15%
- Exams: 25%
- Assignments/Projects: 40%
- Final Exam: 15%
- Class Participation: 5%

The standard University Grading Policy will be used to calculate your final letter grade. Your *lowest* quiz and homework grade will be dropped.

NOTE: Even though the university uses 4.0 GPA scale in it's policy, grades will usually be displayed on a typical 100 point scale on D2L. You can convert from the 100 point scale to 4.0 GPA using the formula below, where **X** is the percentage. $\frac{X}{20} - 1 = \text{GPA}$

Exams/Quizzes:

Exams and Quizzes times will be announced during class and must be taken during their scheduled time/location. Students who are unable to take the exam or quiz at the scheduled time for university approved reasons, **must do their best to contact the instructor before the start of it**. No make-ups will be allowed otherwise. For a list of approved reasons review the *Class Absence* section in the Class Attendance university policy.

Homework (Assignments/Projects):

Homework will be announced during class time. Most assignments will be submitted through D2L unless otherwise stated. Students will be allotted three (3) "free-late-days" during the semester. Students can use these days to submit assignments up to their remaining number of days late without penalty.

For Example: Spike has submitted all his assignments on time, but forgot about the latest assignment. He decides to use two (2) of his "free-late-days" to work on the assignment and submit it. He'll receive the same grade as if he had submitted it on time, but is now left with one (1) "free-late-days."

Students without remaining "free-late-days" will no longer receive credit on assignments submitted after the due date and time. Days are counted immediately after the due date and time. Meaning if an assignment is due at 11:59PM on Friday, an assignment submitted at 12:01AM Saturday will use one of your free days.

Continuing from above: Spike has once again forgotten about his assignment. He forgets that he had already used 2 of his 3 days and submits the assignment 2 days after it's due date. Since Spike only had one day left, the assignment will receive a zero for late submission. Spike will also no longer have any "free-late-days".

Course Policies

COVID-19 Related

Course Modularity: This course is running a hybrid format with course content being presented simultaneously via Zoom and in the designated classroom. A rotation schedule will be provided before the start of the semester. Students can request to be allowed in the classroom everyday if the room isn't at capacity. Students who have registered with the DSO and provided the instructor with their letter will be given priority. Students attending in-person are encouraged to bring a pair of wired earbuds/headphones in the case of group work on Zoom. These devices should be put away in all other cases.

Class Recording: Most lectures will be recorded through the semester by the instructor. A recording consent form will be provided within the first week of class.

Masks: Current research suggest that the use of face coverings helps reduce the spread of the COVID-19 causing virus. Students attending class in-person will be required to wear a mask/face covering properly (covering their nose and mouth) at all times. This policy expands to any classroom, public area, and common area on campus. Any student not wearing wearing a mask properly will be asked to leave the classroom and will still be responsible for any missed work. Please refer to this link for more information. In the case that a student refuses to wear a mask after being asked to so, the class will be moved online for that session.

Other Policies

Attendance

Regular class attendance and participation is expected and highly encouraged. Students will be responsible for all materials covered during class time.

Collaboration

Academic Dishonesty

Classroom Etiquette

Course Work / Accreditation

E-Mail Correspondence

Students with Disabilities

Gender-Based Crimes

NOTE: This document is subject to changes at the discretion of the instructor